



Don't Die *Retired*

90-DAY WORKBOOK

Second Act

The 90-day venture workbook



90

Printable • Written for everyone over 50

Whether you've always been active or never got round to it

dontdieretired.com

WELCOME

Second Act

The 90-day venture workbook. Retirement is a word for leaving a job, not a description of a person — and this 90-day workbook is written for anyone over 50 who wants to do more, not less, whether you've always been active or never got round to it.

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Print it

It's made for paper. Pin the tracker pages somewhere you'll see them every day.

Start small

Every plan has a beginner's route. Doing a little, often, beats doing a lot once.

Tick the box

A row of ticks is surprisingly powerful. It's how a habit becomes part of your life.

This workbook is general information for people in the UK. It is not financial, legal or tax advice; rules change and your circumstances are your own. Check current guidance on [gov.uk](https://www.gov.uk) and speak to an accountant or adviser before committing money. © Don't Die Retired. For personal use; please don't share or resell. Thank you for supporting an independent project.

A practical, ninety-day route from an idea to your first paying customer, or your first funded or served beneficiary, for people over fifty who have a feeling they are not done yet. It is built around one rule: you will find out whether this works without putting your pension, your savings or your peace of mind at risk.

You may have a clear idea already: a consultancy built on thirty years of knowing how something is done, a craft that friends keep asking to buy, a course, a service in your town, a charity or a community project. Or you may have nothing more than a restlessness, a sense that the next twenty years contain more than gardening and grandchildren, lovely as both are. Either way, this workbook gives you a structure. Ninety days, three phases, one page of work at a time, and a review at the end where you decide, on evidence, whether to continue, adjust or stop.

It is a workbook, not a textbook. Print it. Write in it. Cross things out. The blank tables are the point. If a page is filled in by the end, the day has done its job.

■ How this works

- **Days 1 to 30: Find the problem.** You leave the house and talk to ten people who might have the problem you think you can solve. You do not sell anything. You listen and write it down.
- **Days 31 to 60: Make the offer.** You turn what you heard into a one-page offer with a price, build the smallest version you can deliver, and pitch it three times.
- **Days 61 to 90: First customer and review.** You have the sales conversation, deliver well, ask for a referral and a testimonial, and then sit down with the review page and decide.
- Each phase has **worksheets** to fill in, a **weekly plan** to tick off, and a short **troubleshooting** section for when it wobbles.
- There is a **not-a-business variant** throughout, with equivalent milestones, for those whose second act is volunteering, a community project, a portfolio of part-time work or a role with somebody else.

A note on money and law

Everything in this workbook about money, tax, company structure and insurance is general information for people in the UK, written to help you know which questions to ask. It is not financial, legal or tax advice, rules change, and your circumstances are your own. Check current guidance on [gov.uk](https://www.gov.uk) and speak to an accountant or adviser before you commit money or sign anything.

■ Why starting at fifty-plus is a good bet

There is a persistent story that new ventures belong to the young. The research does not support it. Several large studies of founders, in the UK and elsewhere, have found that businesses started by people in their fifties and sixties survive at rates comparable to, and often better than, those started by people in their twenties and thirties. The precise figures vary by study and by sector, so we will not quote one and pretend it is universal. The direction is consistent, and it is not hard to see why.

What you have	Why it matters now
Experience	You have seen what goes wrong. You know which problems are real and which are fashionable. You are hard to fool, including by yourself.
Networks	Decades of colleagues, clients, suppliers and neighbours. Your first ten conversations are probably already in your phone.
Patience	You are not trying to be a millionaire by Christmas. A venture that grows slowly and steadily is a fine outcome, and you can wait for it.
Judgement about people	You can tell within ten minutes whether someone will pay, whether a partner is reliable, whether a promise is worth anything.
Lower fixed costs	Often, though not always, the mortgage is smaller, the children are grown and the need to draw a salary from day one is less pressing.
Credibility	A grey head and a calm manner is an asset in most rooms. People trust it. Use that.

None of this makes it easy. Energy is finite, technology moves quickly, and a good many over-fifty founders undersell themselves out of habit. But the raw materials are better than you may think, and this workbook is designed to use them.

■ **The mindset shift: an experiment, not a lifetime decision**

The single most useful change you can make before Day 1 is to stop thinking of this as **starting a business** and start thinking of it as **running a ninety-day experiment**. The difference is not cosmetic.

- A business needs a name, a logo, a website, a plan, an accountant and a slightly nervous conversation with your partner. An experiment needs a question, a method, a budget and a review date.
- A business that fails is a failure. An experiment that produces a clear answer has succeeded, whatever the answer is.
- A business asks you to commit. An experiment asks you to be curious for thirteen weeks and then decide.
- A business is what you tell people you are doing. An experiment is what you actually do, quietly, until you have something to show.

Your experiment has a **question** (will anyone pay for this, and how much?), a **method** (the ninety days that follow), a **budget** (which you will set on the next page and not exceed) and a **review date** (Day 90, in the diary, in ink). At the review you will choose one of three words: continue, adjust or stop. All three are respectable.

Worksheet 1: my experiment

My question:

My review date (Day 90):

What 'good enough to continue' looks like:

What would make me stop:

Who I will tell (one or two people who will ask how it is going):

.....

■ **Protecting your money**

You are at a stage of life where a financial mistake is harder to recover from than it was at thirty. That is not a reason to do nothing. It is a reason to set rules before you are excited, and to keep them when you are. Here are four.

- 1 No debt.** No loans, no credit cards, no borrowing against the house, no lending from family. If the experiment cannot be run on money you can afford to lose, run a smaller experiment.
- 2 No pension drawdown for the venture.** Your pension is for the decades after this. Money you take out of it early to fund a venture is taxed, is gone, and cannot be put back on the same terms. If the idea needs that much money to test, it is not yet a ninety-day idea.
- 3 Cap the experiment budget and write it down.** For most ideas in this workbook, a few hundred pounds covers the ninety days: a domain name, some printing, travel to meetings, a trial of one piece of software, a batch of materials. Decide the number now. When you reach it, you stop spending, not the experiment.
- 4 Talk to an accountant before the first invoice, not after the first tax return.** One hour of a good local accountant's time, before you take money, will tell you how to register, what to record and what to keep. Many will do a first conversation at low cost or free.

Worksheet 2: my money rules

My experiment budget (total, ninety days): £.....

Where it comes from (not pension, not borrowing):

Spent so far: £..... (update weekly)

Accountant or adviser I will speak to, and when:

Signed by me: Date:

■ **UK basics in plain English**

This is the minimum you need to know to begin. It is general, it is deliberately brief, and the rules change, so treat it as a list of things to check rather than the last word.

	Sole trader	Limited company
What it is	You, trading under your own name or a business name	A separate legal entity you own and direct
Setting up	Register for Self Assessment with HMRC	Register with Companies House, then with HMRC
Paperwork	A tax return once a year, plus your own records	Annual accounts, confirmation statement, Corporation Tax return, payroll if you pay yourself a salary
Liability	You are personally responsible for debts	Generally limited to what the company owns, with exceptions
Privacy	Your details stay largely private	Directors and accounts are on the public register
Cost	Low, often nothing to set up	A registration fee, and usually an accountant
Good for a ninety-day test	Almost always	Rarely, unless a client or funder insists

- **The trading allowance.** In the UK you can currently earn up to £1,000 a year from trading or casual income before you need to declare it or register. This means a small experiment can often begin without any registration at all. Check the current figure and conditions on gov.uk.
- **Self Assessment.** Once you expect to earn more than the allowance, you register with HMRC for Self Assessment, by a deadline that falls after the end of the tax year in which you started. Registering is free and done online.
- **Records.** Keep every receipt and a simple list of money in and money out from Day 1. A notebook or a spreadsheet is fine. It costs nothing and it makes the accountant conversation short.
- **Insurance.** If you give advice, consider professional indemnity. If people come to your premises or you go to theirs, consider public liability. If you make things people eat, wear or put in their homes, ask about product liability. Many trade bodies offer members' cover; a broker can quote in a day.
- **Pensions and benefits.** If you receive the State Pension or any benefit, earnings can affect some of them. Check before you start, not after.
- **Charities and community projects.** A small unincorporated association with a simple constitution and a bank account is usually enough to test an idea. Formal charity registration comes later, if at all. Your local Council for Voluntary Service will help for free.

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The experiment is not 'can I build a company'. It is 'will someone pay for this'. Answer the second question first. The first one is paperwork.

From the workbook

01 Days 1 to 30: Find the problem

The most common way a venture fails is not that the founder built something badly. It is that they built something nobody had a pressing enough problem to pay for. This month exists to save you from that, and it requires you to talk to people before you make anything.

■ Week 1: the problem statement

Write down, in one sentence, the problem you believe you can solve, for whom, and what it costs them now. Not your idea. The problem. If you are a retired surveyor who wants to help first-time buyers avoid bad houses, the problem is not 'people need a surveyor'. It is 'first-time buyers in this town spend thousands on homes with faults they could have spotted, because they do not know what to look for and cannot afford a full survey on every viewing'.

Worksheet 3: the problem statement	Your answer
Who has the problem? (be specific: a type of person, in a place)	
What is the problem, in their words, not yours?	
What does it cost them now? (money, time, worry, missed chances)	
How do they solve it today, if at all?	
Why is that solution not good enough?	
Why am I the person to help with this?	
My one-sentence problem statement:	

■ Weeks 2 to 4: ten conversations

Now you find ten people who might have this problem and you talk to each of them for twenty to thirty minutes. In person or on the phone; video if you must. You are not selling. You are not even describing your idea until the end, and then only if they ask. You are finding out whether the problem is real, how much it hurts, and what they would do about it.

Ten sounds like a lot. It is not. Your address book, your former colleagues, the people at the club, the parents at the school gate, your neighbours and their grown-up children will supply most of them. For the rest, a polite message to a local Facebook group or a note on the community noticeboard works remarkably well when it comes from someone with grey hair and no agenda.



The conversation script

Opening: 'Thank you for giving me half an hour. I am looking into [the area], and I am trying to understand how people deal with [the problem] before I decide whether to do anything about it. I am not selling anything. I would just like to hear about your experience.'

Ask: 'Tell me about the last time you dealt with [the problem]. What happened?'

Ask: 'What did you try? What worked, what did not?'

Ask: 'How much did it cost you, in money or time or aggravation?'

Ask: 'If you could wave a wand, what would happen instead?'

Ask: 'Have you ever paid anyone to help with this? What did you pay? Was it worth it?'

Ask: 'If something existed that [did the thing], roughly what would you expect to pay for it?'

Ask: 'Who else do you know who has this problem? Would you introduce me?'

Close: 'That was genuinely useful. May I come back to you in a few weeks if I decide to try something?'

Then, straight afterwards, before you drive home, fill in a row of the log. Not what you wished they had said. What they said.

#	Who (initials, type)	Has the problem? Y/N	How much it hurts (1 to 5)	What they pay or do now	Would pay roughly	Introduced me to
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						

■ Reading the log: what would they pay?

On Day 30, sit down with the ten rows and be honest. You are looking for a pattern, not a unanimous vote. Ask yourself three questions.

- **How many have the problem, and how badly?** If seven or more say yes and score it three or above, you have something. If three or fewer do, you probably have the wrong people or the wrong problem, and the kindest thing is to go back to Worksheet 3 rather than press on.
- **What did they actually pay, or say they would pay?** Write the range down. Ignore the person who said 'I would pay anything' and the person who said 'I would never pay for that'. The middle six are your market.
- **Who offered to introduce you?** An introduction is worth more than a compliment. If two or more people volunteered names without being pushed, the problem is real enough that they want it solved.

Worksheet 4: Day 30 verdict	Your answer
Number who clearly have the problem (out of 10)	
Average 'how much it hurts' score	
Price range mentioned (low to high)	
The phrase I heard more than once	
Number of introductions offered	
Do I go to Phase 2? (Yes / Go back / Stop)	

02 Days 31 to 60: Make the offer

You now know a problem is real, roughly what it costs people and roughly what they will pay. This month you turn that into something you can put in front of someone and say: here it is, this is the price, would you like it?

■ Week 5: the one-page offer

An offer is a promise with a price attached. It is not a business plan and it is not a brochure. It fits on one side of A4 and it answers five questions, in this order, in the plainest words you can manage.

Worksheet 5: my one-page offer	Your answer
Who it is for (one type of person)	
The problem it solves (their words, from the log)	
What I will actually do or provide (be concrete: hours, items, sessions, outcomes)	
What it costs (one number, or a clear 'from')	
What happens next if they say yes (how they book, pay, start)	
Why me (two sentences of relevant experience, no adjectives)	
A plain guarantee or reassurance (for example, 'if the first session is not useful, you do not pay')	

■ Week 6: pricing three ways

Most over-fifty founders price too low. Partly modesty, partly the fear that nobody will pay, partly a habit of thinking in terms of an hourly wage. Do the sums three ways and then choose the highest of the three you can say out loud without flinching.

Method	How to do it	Your number
Cost plus	Add up what it costs you to deliver (materials, travel, software, your hours at a rate you would accept from an employer) and add a margin of at least a third.	£
Market rate	What do others charge for something similar? Look at three. Place yourself in the middle or above, never at the bottom. You are not competing on price at this age.	£
Value to the customer	From your log: what does the problem cost them? A price that is a fraction of that cost is easy for them to justify. If you save someone £5,000, £500 is not expensive.	£

Method	How to do it	Your number
The price I will use	Usually the highest of the three. Write it down and stop adjusting it.	£

Three pricing habits worth keeping

Quote in writing, always, before you start. A short email is enough.

Offer a package (for example, three sessions, a fixed job, a bundle of items) rather than an hourly rate wherever you can. Packages are easier to buy and stop you being haggled down by the hour.

Never discount for a stranger. If someone cannot afford it, offer a smaller package, not a cheaper one.

■ **Week 7: the minimum viable version**

You do not need the finished thing to sell the first one. You need the smallest version that fully solves the problem for one person. A consultant's minimum version is a two-hour session and a written summary. A craft maker's is one product in one size, made to order. A course is a live session for six people in a hired room or on a video call, not a website full of recorded lessons. A community project is one event, one Saturday, one hall.

Worksheet 6: the minimum version	Your answer
The smallest thing I can deliver that solves the whole problem for one customer	
What I will NOT include yet (the list of things I keep wanting to build)	
What it costs me to deliver one (money and hours)	
How long it takes me to deliver one	
What I need to have ready before the first pitch (keep this to five items or fewer)	

■ **Week 8: a landing page or a simple flyer, and three pitches**

You need one place to point people to. That is all. A single web page with your offer on it and a way to contact you, or, for a local service, an A5 flyer that says the same thing. Do not build a website with six pages and a blog. The one-page offer you wrote in Week 5 is the content; your job this week is to put it somewhere people can see it.

- **For a web page**, there are free and cheap tools that give you a single page in an afternoon. Choose one that a friend or grandchild already knows; the point is to spend a day on it, not a month. Buy the domain name if you like; it costs a few pounds a year.
- **For a flyer**, a plain design with your offer, your price, your name and a phone number, printed at the local print shop, works. Fifty copies is plenty.

- **For either**, one photograph of you, looking like yourself, is worth more than any stock image.
- Then make **three pitches** before Day 60. Go back to the three people from your log who scored the problem highest or offered introductions. Show them the offer. Ask if they would like it. You are not expecting three yeses. You are expecting to learn what they say when a price is attached, which is a different thing entirely from what they said when it was hypothetical.

Pitch	Who	Response (Yes / Not now / No)	What they said about the price	What they said about the offer	What I will change
1					
2					
3					

03 Days 61 to 90: First customer and review

Everything so far has been preparation. This month you take money, or a signed-up beneficiary, or a funded event. Then you deliver well, ask for two things, and sit down with the review page.

■ Week 9: the sales conversation

Selling is not persuading someone to want something they do not want. It is helping someone who has the problem decide whether your offer is the right way to solve it. Done properly it feels like the conversations you had in Phase 1, with a decision at the end. Here is a shape that works.

The sales conversation script

Reconnect: 'When we spoke before, you told me about [the problem]. Is that still the case?'

Confirm: 'What would it be worth to you to have that sorted by [date]?'

Present: 'Here is what I would do.' (Walk through the one-page offer. Stop talking when you reach the price.)

Ask: 'Would you like to go ahead?'

If yes: 'Good. Here is what happens next.' (Payment, dates, what you need from them.)

If hesitant: 'What is holding you back?' Then listen. Answer the real objection, not the one you expected.

If no: 'Thank you for being straight with me. May I ask what would have made it a yes?'

Objection	What it usually means	What to say
'It is too expensive'	Value not yet clear, or the wrong package	'Compared with what it is costing you now?' Or offer a smaller package at the same rate, not a discount.
'I need to think about it'	Fear of deciding, or they need to ask someone	'Of course. What specifically would help you decide?' Fix a date to speak again.
'I can do it myself'	They have not, and probably will not	'You could. What has stopped you so far?' Then be quiet.
'I am not sure you are the right person'	They want reassurance about you	Give one concrete example from your experience and offer the guarantee.
'Not right now'	Timing, or a polite no	'When would be a better time? I will get in touch then.' Write the date down and do it.

Objection	What it usually means	What to say
'Can you do it cheaper?'	They want to feel they got a deal	'I do not discount, but I can take out [element] and bring it to £X.'

■ Week 10 and 11: delivering well

Your first customer is the most important one you will ever have, not because of the money but because of what they will say afterwards. Over-deliver on care, not on scope. That means:

- ☐ Confirm everything in writing the same day: what, when, where, how much, what you need from them.
- ☐ Take payment, or at least a deposit, before you start. It is not rude. It is how business is done, and it saves awkwardness later.
- ☐ Turn up early, prepared, with more than you need.
- ☐ Do exactly what the offer said. Resist the urge to add the extra things you left out of the minimum version. Note them for later.
- ☐ Check in halfway: 'Is this what you were expecting? Anything you would like more or less of?'
- ☐ Finish on time and send a short written summary of what was done and what they might do next.
- ☐ Keep a record of hours and costs so you know what the job really took.

■ Week 12: the referral and the testimonial

Within a week of finishing, while the customer is still pleased, ask for two things. Most people are glad to help and simply need to be asked plainly.

The two asks

For a testimonial: 'I am at the start of this and a few words from you would help enormously. Would you be willing to write two or three sentences about what it was like and what you got from it? Or, if easier, I can draft something from what you have told me and you can change it.'

For a referral: 'Do you know one or two other people who have the same problem? Would you be happy to introduce me, or may I mention that you suggested I get in touch?'

Worksheet 7: first customer record	Your answer
Who (initials) and what they bought	
Price paid and date	
Hours it actually took me	
Costs it actually incurred	

Worksheet 7: first customer record	Your answer
What went well	
What I would change	
Testimonial received? (paste it in)	
Referrals received (names or initials)	

■ Week 13: the 90-day review

This is the page the whole workbook has been leading towards. Set aside a quiet hour with the logs, the pitch table, the customer record and Worksheet 1. Fill in the table below honestly and then choose one word. You told at least one person you would do this. Do it.

Worksheet 8: the review	Your answer
Conversations held (target 10)	
Pitches made (target 3)	
Paying customers or funded/served beneficiaries (target 1)	
Money in: £	
Money out: £ (against budget of £)	
Hours spent, roughly	
Did I enjoy it? (honestly, 1 to 5)	
Did it fit around the rest of my life?	
What surprised me	
What I got wrong at the start	
Compared with Worksheet 1: did I reach 'good enough to continue'?	

Continue	Adjust	Stop
You had at least one paying customer, you enjoyed it, and the money in and hours out make sense. Set a new ninety-day experiment with a bigger target (three customers, say) and a slightly larger budget. Now is the time for the accountant conversation and, if needed, registration.	Something real is there but the offer, the price or the customer type is wrong. Change one thing, not three, and run a shorter experiment: thirty days, three more pitches. Do not spend more until it works.	No paying customer, or one who made you miserable, or the numbers are simply not there. Stop, cleanly, and be proud: you found out for a few hundred pounds what others spend years and a redundancy payment discovering. Write down what you learned. Another idea will come, and you now know how to test it.

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Stopping an experiment that has given you a clear answer is not quitting. It is the whole point of running one.

From the workbook

04 The 13-week plan

One row a week. Fill in the date, do the thing in the middle column, tick the box. If a week slips, do not double up; simply move everything along by a week. The ninety days is a rhythm, not a deadline.

Week	Days	This week I will	Done
1	1 to 7	Write Worksheet 1 (my experiment) and Worksheet 2 (money rules). Draft the problem statement (Worksheet 3). List 15 possible people to talk to.	
2	8 to 14	Book and hold conversations 1 to 3. Fill in the log straight after each.	
3	15 to 21	Conversations 4 to 7. Ask each person for one introduction.	
4	22 to 30	Conversations 8 to 10. Read the log. Complete Worksheet 4 (Day 30 verdict). Decide: go on, go back, or stop.	
5	31 to 37	Write the one-page offer (Worksheet 5). Read it aloud to one person who will be honest.	
6	38 to 44	Price it three ways. Choose the number. Write it on the offer.	
7	45 to 51	Define the minimum version (Worksheet 6). Prepare the five things needed to deliver it.	
8	52 to 60	Build the landing page or print the flyer. Make three pitches. Fill in the pitch table.	
9	61 to 67	Follow up all three pitches. Hold at least two sales conversations. Take a deposit from the first yes.	
10	68 to 74	Deliver to the first customer (part one). Keep the hours and costs record.	
11	75 to 81	Deliver (part two). Send the written summary. Check money spent against budget.	
12	82 to 88	Ask for the testimonial and referral. Complete Worksheet 7. Book the accountant conversation if continuing.	
13	89 to 90	The review. Complete Worksheet 8. Choose: continue, adjust or stop. Tell the person you said you would tell.	

05 The not-a-business variant

Not every second act involves invoices. If yours is volunteering, a community project, a mix of part-time roles or a job with someone else, the ninety days works just as well. The milestones change; the discipline of finding a real need, making a clear offer and reviewing on evidence does not.

Phase	Business version	Volunteering or community project	Portfolio career or part-time work
Days 1 to 30	Ten conversations with potential customers. Problem statement. Day 30 verdict.	Ten conversations with people affected by the need, and with two or three organisations already working on it. Is the gap real, or is someone already filling it?	Ten conversations with people doing the kind of work you want, or who hire for it. What do they actually need, and what does it pay?
Days 31 to 60	One-page offer, priced three ways. Minimum version. Three pitches.	A one-page project outline: who it helps, what happens, what it costs to run, who else needs to agree. Apply for one small grant, or approach one funder or host venue. Pitch to three possible partners or volunteers.	A one-page 'what I offer' sheet. Decide your day rate or hours. Apply for, or pitch, three roles or pieces of work.
Days 61 to 90	First paying customer. Deliver. Testimonial, referral, review.	First event, session or beneficiary served, with funding or a venue secured. Ask for a quote from a beneficiary and an introduction to a second partner. Review.	First paid day or first month in role. Ask for a reference and one further introduction. Review.
The review question	Did someone pay, and does it add up?	Did the need turn out to be real, did someone show up, and can it run without exhausting me?	Does the work fit my life, does it pay enough, and do I want more of it?

- **Money rules still apply.** Do not fund a community project from your own pocket beyond the experiment budget, and never from your pension. A project that cannot attract a small grant or a free venue in ninety days is telling you something.
- **Insurance and safeguarding matter more, not less,** when you are working with the public, especially with children or vulnerable adults. Your local Council for Voluntary Service can advise on both for free.
- **For portfolio and part-time work,** the same Self Assessment and trading allowance rules apply if you are freelancing. If you are employed by someone else, they handle the tax and you need do nothing.

06 Troubleshooting

Every venture wobbles. Here are the six wobbles we hear about most and what to do about each.

The wobble	What is usually going on	What to do
Nobody replies	You are asking strangers, asking vaguely, or asking by the wrong channel.	Start with people who know you. Ask for a specific twenty minutes on a specific day. Phone rather than email. Ask each person for one introduction so the chain never breaks.
Fear of selling	You are picturing a salesman. You are not one; you are someone offering to solve a problem they told you they have.	Re-read your log before every pitch. Use the script. Say the price and then stop talking. Remember that a no costs you nothing and teaches you something.
Partner not keen	They are worried about money, time or your wellbeing, and have not seen the rules you set.	Show them Worksheet 1 and 2. A capped budget, no debt, no pension and a review date answers most of it. Agree what 'this is taking over' would look like and promise to notice.
Tech overwhelm	You are trying to build a system before you have a customer.	You need one page online and a way to take a payment. Nothing else for ninety days. Ask one younger person for one afternoon, and buy them lunch.
Pricing too low	Habit, modesty and the hourly-wage mindset.	Go back to the value-to-customer column. Add a third. Quote it in writing. If more than half say yes without hesitation, you are still too cheap.
Over-building	It is more comfortable to make things than to talk to people.	Look at Worksheet 6, the list of what you are not including yet. Everything you are building this week should be on the 'included' side. If it is not, stop and make a phone call instead.

■ Two more, quietly

- **Energy.** You are not fifty at thirty. Plan the ninety days around your good hours, whether that is early mornings or after lunch. Two focused hours a day, five days a week, is more than enough to do everything in this workbook. Guard your sleep; it is your best business asset.
- **Loneliness.** Working on something alone after decades in a team can be unexpectedly quiet. Find one other person doing something similar and speak weekly. The members' circle at dontdieretired.com exists for exactly this.

07 What happens next

Whatever word you chose at the review, you have done something most people only talk about. You took an idea out of your head, tested it against real people and real money, and got an answer. That is a habit, and habits repeat.

- **If you chose continue**, set the next ninety-day experiment today, with a bigger target and the same rules. Book the accountant. Register if you have passed the trading allowance. Tell your first customer that you are carrying on; they will be pleased.
- **If you chose adjust**, change one thing and run thirty days. Do not buy anything new until the thirty days is up.
- **If you chose stop**, write one page on what you learned and put this workbook somewhere you will find it again. The next idea deserves the same method.

■ Keep going with us

The newsletter. Once a week at dontdieretired.com we send a short, practical email for people over fifty who intend to keep going: something to try, some evidence explained without the jargon, and, regularly, a real story of someone who started something later than the books say you should. No hype, no miracle schemes, and you can leave any time. Sign up at dontdieretired.com.

The members' circle. For those who want company on the way, the circle is a small, paid group of people running their own second acts: a monthly conversation, a place to ask the awkward questions about pricing and partners and paperwork, and a set of people who will ask you how the ninety days is going and actually want to know. Details are at dontdieretired.com.

Our other workbooks. A second act needs a body and a mind that will carry it. The 30-Day Restart and Strong at 60 are for the body; Sharp is for the mind. All three are at dontdieretired.com.



Before you close the book

Write the Day 90 review date in your diary now.

Tell one person.

Make the first phone call this week.

“

You do not need permission, a plan or a logo. You need ten conversations, one offer and a date to decide. Everything else is detail.

Second Act

This workbook is general information, not financial, legal or tax advice. Rules about tax, company registration, benefits and pensions change; check current guidance at gov.uk and speak to a qualified adviser about your own circumstances before you commit money or sign anything.

KEEP GOING

This is the start, not the finish.

Every day at dontdieretired.com we publish a true story of someone who began something late — and the plan behind it. Join the free Sunday email and you'll get one story, one idea and one thing to try each week.

MORE FROM THE SHELF

The 30-Day Restart

Ten minutes a day, chair to stairs

Strong at 60

12-week beginner strength plan

Eat Strong

Four-week kitchen planner

Sharp

8 weeks to a learning habit

The Money Reset

30-day money workbook

Reconnect

Six weeks to a fuller social life



Don't Die *Retired*

Retire from work if you like. Never from life. · dontdieretired.com · hello@dontdieretired.com